

To truly take advantage of actionable insights and real-time response on edge devices, both reliable, resilient storage and powerful analytical tools will need to reside at the edge. Here, timeliness is critical, as this actually converts content into context and passive decisions into informed decisions.

Embedded solutions help capture, aggregate, transform and preserve data across IoT devices that range from smartphones, drones and surveillance cameras, to connected cars, appliances, personal devices, sensors and more. These devices reside at the edge where our embedded solutions work behind the scenes in increasingly smaller, but simultaneously more powerful solutions. AI is hard at work at the edge, analysing and processing data to give real-time feedback.

What lies ahead

AI seems to be touching our lives at every turn. Typically, you listen to radio traffic reports during your morning commute. You might hear about a car accident on the radio and take a different route. Today, AI-infused talking personal assistants on our smartphones can tell you the best way home and even reroute you along the way. Thanks to them, we know more about our surroundings than ever before.

We are also starting to learn more about what's going on inside the human body. There are new edge devices that go beyond tracking steps, heart rates and calories burned. These

devices are enabled by AI to have machine learning (ML) capabilities. They can detect early signs of sickness or stress and suggest appropriate courses of action, such as giving you instructions to take your vitamins, get some sleep, or go see a doctor! The so-called 'empathetic AI' to help with depression is already in use, and will only be advanced to help us live a healthier and more fulfilling life.

Although we are seeing more AI-driven applications in our everyday life, AI is still in its infancy. We've only scratched the surface of what it can become. As we can see from a series of talks by Jason Silva, a technology enthusiast and self-proclaimed futurist, data is now alive. It's talking back to us. It's driving IoT to ultimately become a world of intelligence, by leveraging the edge. **END** 🐧

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The author is director-product marketing, India, Western Digital, and works with the company's embedded and integrated storage solutions. In this role, he is tasked with understanding customer pain points and recommending the best storage solutions that address these. He has been with Western Digital, including the SanDisk brand team, for six years. Prior to this, he was with Intel Corp. for 12 years. He has an MBA from the Haas School of Business, University of California, Berkeley, and a master's degree in electronics engineering from Arizona State University.

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